

Imatinib Compared with Interferon and Low-Dose Cytarabine for Newly Diagnosed Chronic-Phase Chronic Myeloid Leukemia

O'Brien SG, Guilhot F, Larson RA, et al.

BACKGROUND: Imatinib mesylate (Gleevec) is a specific inhibitor of the BCR-ABL tyrosine kinase, the causative molecular abnormality of chronic myeloid leukemia (CML).

RESULTS: After a median follow-up of 19 months, the estimated rate of a major cytogenetic response at 18 months was 87.1% in the imatinib group, as compared with 34.7% in the combination-therapy group ($P<0.001$).

CONCLUSION: Imatinib is superior to interferon alfa plus low-dose cytarabine as first-line therapy in newly diagnosed chronic-phase CML.